# HKUST Canvas Student Guide

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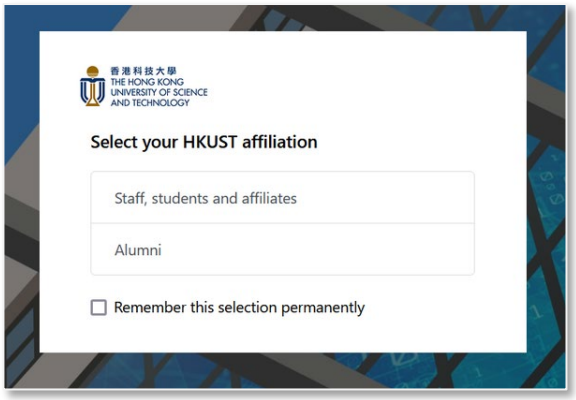
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# 1 Canvas Access and Interface

## 1.1 How can I log in to Canvas?

1) Open a web browser and go to https://canvas.ust.hk.
2) Select the correct account type and log in with your full primary email address in the format account@connect.ust.hk (not just your account name) along with your password.




If you have trouble logging in, please contact the ITSO Helpdesk via email at cchelp@ust.hk or call 2358-6200.

## 1.2 What are the browser and computer requirements for using Canvas?

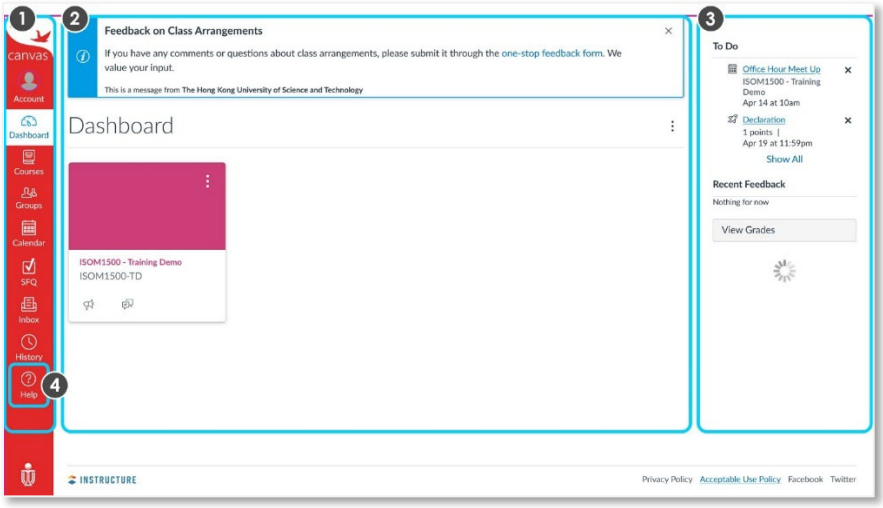
Canvas is designed to work on most devices and requires minimal specifications. You should always use the most current version of your preferred browser (Chrome, Firefox, Edge, or Safari) with an operating system that can run the latest compatible web browsers. Cookies and JavaScript should be enabled.

For detailed information, please visit: Browser and computer requirements for Canvas.

## 1.3 What can I see and do after I log in to Canvas?

After logging in, you will land on your Dashboard. The Dashboard provides an overview of activities across all your courses and helps you keep track of upcoming tasks.

The Dashboard includes four main elements:



1. **Global Navigation** - Found on the left side of every page, Global Navigation gives quick access to your Courses, Groups, Calendar, SFQ, and Inbox. You can expand or collapse this menu using the arrow at the bottom. Learn more about Global Navigation.
2. **Dashboard Course Cards -** Each favourite course shows as a card with up to four tabs displaying Announcements, Assignments, Discussions, and Files. Visibility of these tabs mirrors your course navigation settings. Notifications for new items appear on the Discussions and Announcements tabs. Learn more about the Dashboard.
3. **Sidebar -** Shows what needs your attention across all courses, including To-Do lists, upcoming events, grades, and SFQ requests.
4. **Help -** Access guides and support resources for Canvas from anywhere within the platform.

## 1.4 How do I view my courses?

To view your courses, click the Courses icon in the Global Navigation menu on the left. Select the course from the dropdown list. If your course is not shown there, select All Courses to see the complete list. Learn more about viewing courses.

## 1.5 How do I customize my Course list?

If you are enrolled in many courses, you can customise which courses appear in your Courses menu and on your Dashboard by starring your favourite courses. Only starred courses appear on your Dashboard. If no courses are starred, the list shows up to 20 courses alphabetically by default. Learn more about customizing your Course list.

## 1.6 Will Canvas work on my mobile device?

Yes! You can access Canvas through your mobile device's web browser or the official Canvas app by Instructure.

- Search for "canvas.ust.hk" in the app to find the HKUST Canvas site.
- Log in with your HKUST account.

**Note:** Some features may not be fully available on the app depending on your device. Learn more about using Canvas on mobile devices. Download the **HKUST iLearn for Students**  | 

## 1.7 How do I resolve Canvas Mobile App issues?

The Canvas mobile app provides convenient access to your course information on the go. However, it may occasionally encounter issues. Click to check if your device meets the required settings.

**Key Troubleshooting Steps:**

- **Update the App:** Ensure you are using the latest version from the App Store or Google Play.
- **Clear Cache & Data:**
  - **iOS**: Go to **Settings** > **Canvas** > Toggle on "Reset cache on next launch".
  - **Android**: Go to **Settings** > **Apps** > **Canvas** > **Storage** > **Clear Cache/Data**.
- **Reinstall:** Delete the app and reinstall it to fix corrupted files.
- **Check Connection:** Ensure a stable internet connection.
- **Browser Access:** If the app fails, use a mobile web browser or computer instead.

**Note:** We do not recommend submitting assignments or taking quizzes via the mobile app, particularly for assessments that significantly impact your grade. Always use a computer for such coursework.

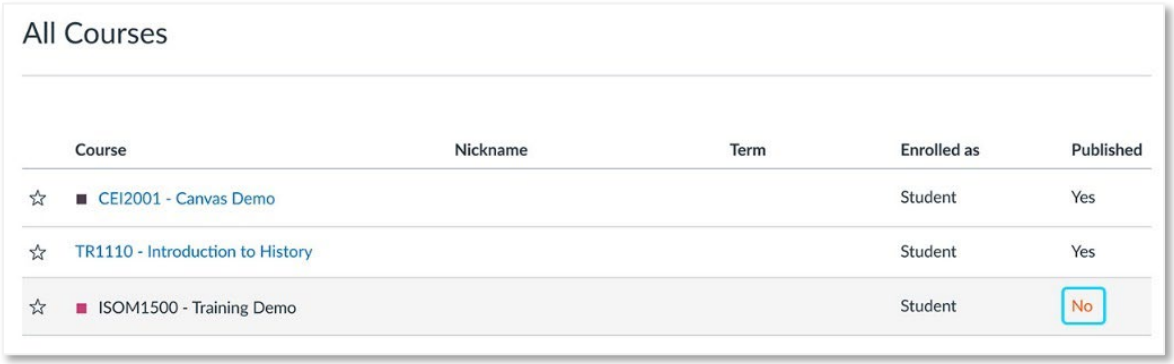
## 1.8 Why can't I find a course I'm enrolled in listed in Canvas?

Several reasons might explain why a course does not appear:

- **Dashboard Course Limit:** The Dashboard shows up to 20 active, published courses by default. Check **Courses** > **All Courses** for your full list. Star your favourite courses to make them appear on the Dashboard, and remember to update after each term.
- **Enrollment Confirmed:** If a course appears under All Courses, you have been successfully enrolled.
- **Course Not Published:** Unpublished courses appear dimmed with a **No** under the **Published** column. Instructors choose when to publish. Contact instructors or check the class schedule on SIS for details.
- **Processing Time:** Enrollment data syncs from HKUST SIS daily. Wait up to 24 hours after enrolling/dropping a course for it to reflect in Canvas.
- **Waitlist Status:** Students on waitlists gain access only after official enrollment.
- **Missing Course After Waiting:** If your course is missing 24 hours after enrollment, email canvas@ust.hk with the course code and section for help.

## 1.9 Why can't I access a course listed in Canvas?

Not all HKUST courses use Canvas; it's up to the instructor. Unpublished courses appear dimmed and inaccessible. Check with your instructor or consult SIS for official course information. Also, ensure your browser and apps are up to date.




## 1.10 Why can't I find my class timetable in Canvas Calendar?

The Canvas Calendar only shows Canvas course assignments and events. The official timetable is available through the Student Information System (SIS).

## 1.11 Can I change my email notification preferences?

Yes, you can customize notifications for each category, choosing from: Right Away, Daily, Weekly, or Never. You can set preferences globally, which apply to all your courses, or per course.

- We recommend setting **Announcements** to **Notify Immediately** to stay updated on important messages.
- Mobile app push notification settings override browser settings. Some preferences may not be supported in the app.

Learn more and adjust your notifications here: Canvas notification | How to manage my notification settings. Also available for: Android | iOS

### 1.12 What happens to the course site after the course end date?

After the course end date, your Canvas course becomes read-only. You can still view published content but cannot participate in activities like submissions or discussions. Some instructors may unpublish materials or hide the course. Contact your instructor or TA for details.

### 1.13 What to do if I encounter an error when viewing pages saying "Disallowed Key Characters"?

Try these steps:

- Update your browser to the latest version.
- Clear your browser's cache and cookies.
- Restart your browser.
- If using bookmarks, navigate to pages from the main Canvas site instead of directly.

Learn how to clear your browser cache here: Clearing cache and cookies

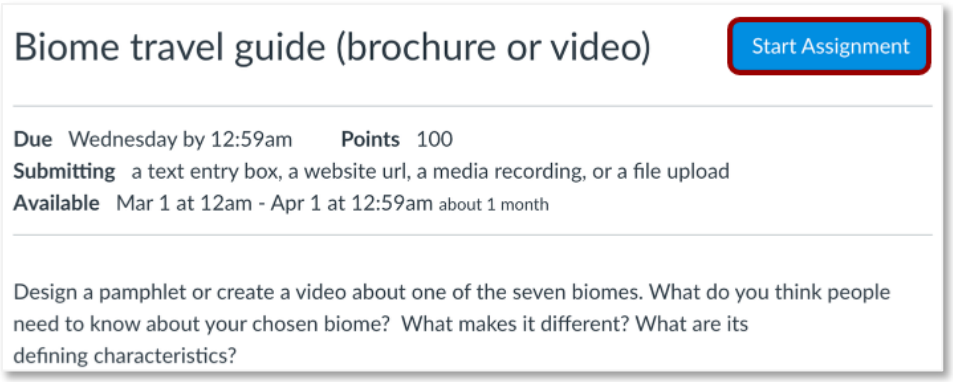
## 2 Participate in a Canvas Course

### 2.1 What are Modules?

Modules are used by your instructor to organize course materials like files, pages, videos, assessments, discussions, and more. Think of the Modules tab as the course's table of contents. Depending on your instructor, modules may be organized by weeks, lectures, or topics. Learn more about Modules.

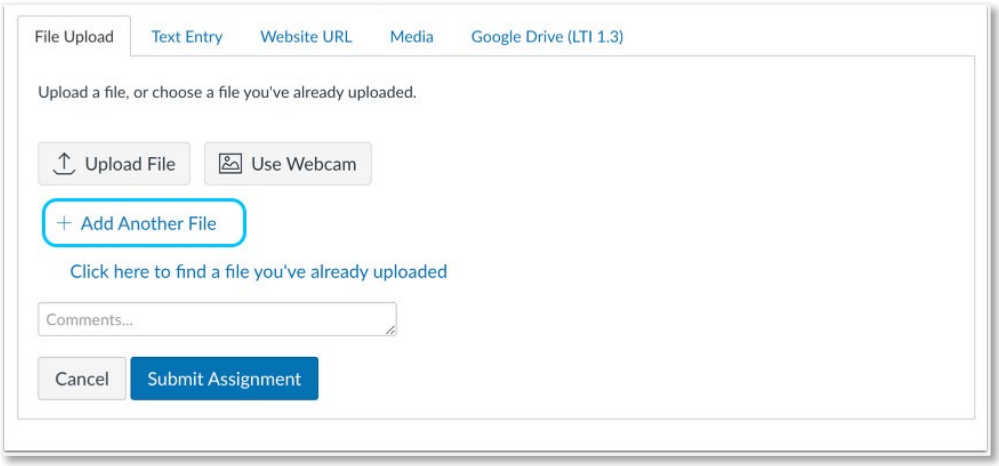
### 2.2 How do I submit an online assignment?

Find the assignment you want to submit, usually located within Modules or Assignments. You might also find a link in the Syllabus or your To Do list. Open the assignment, then click the **Start Assignment** button in the top right menu. Learn more about submitting assignments.



## 2.3 Can I attach multiple files to an online assignment?

Yes! After uploading your first file, click **+ Add Another File** just below the upload area to add more files.

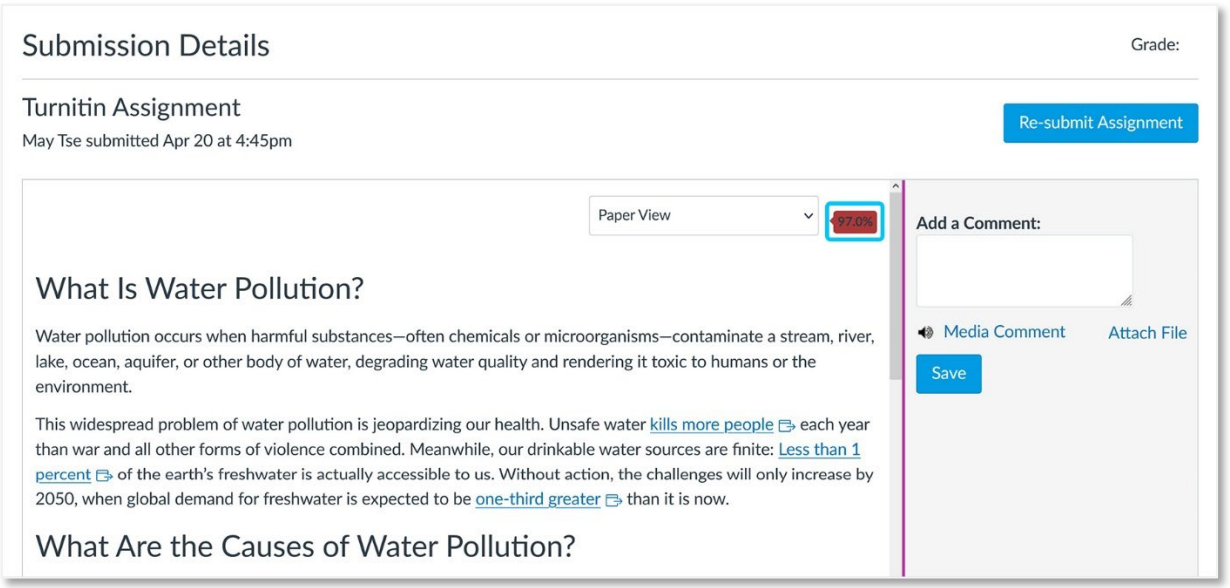



## 2.4 What happens if I resubmit an assignment?

Whether you can resubmit depends on your instructor's settings. If resubmissions are allowed, Canvas keeps all submitted files for your instructor to view, but you will only see your most recent submission. If you accidentally resubmit, inform your instructor, as they might grade only your latest submission.

## 2.5 How do I submit a Turnitin Assignment?

Turnitin is integrated with Canvas Assignments. Once your instructor sets it up, submit your assignment through Canvas like any other assignment. You may be able to submit multiple files. If allowed, you can view the similarity report by clicking **Submission Details** on the right side of your assignment page. The similarity score will appear as a percentage icon.



## 2.6 What are some important tips for taking a quiz in Canvas?

To do well on quizzes, understand how to navigate, manage time, and avoid technical problems.

**Before the Quiz:**

- Learn to navigate questions, use the question list, and flag questions to revisit during the quiz.
- Use a reliable device and stable internet; avoid mobile apps if possible.
- Use recommended browsers (Chrome, Firefox), keep them updated, avoid private/incognito mode, and close extra tabs/windows.
- Read quiz instructions carefully (time limits, attempts, answer visibility).
- Note quiz due and lock dates.

**During the Quiz:**

- Keep an eye on the timer.
- Use the question navigator and flag questions for review.
- Avoid multiple browser tabs or windows.
- Submit your quiz properly; leaving the page doesn't submit it!
- Review answers if allowed.

**Additional Tips:**

- Canvas records your quiz activity.
- Use reliable technology.
- Contact your instructor or TA immediately if problems occur.
- Understand quiz rules as they may differ between quizzes.

More details: How to Take a Quiz in Canvas

## 2.7 How do I upload and embed media files from my computer using the Rich Content Editor?

You can upload and embed supported media files directly into any location in Canvas that is using the Rich Content Editor. Canvas supports files up to 500 MB; larger files can be hosted externally (e.g., YouTube) and embedded. Learn more about uploading media files.

## 2.8 How do I view my Grades?

You can view a summary of your grades for all courses from the View Grades section on the Dashboard sidebar. Within individual courses, use the Grades link in the course's left menu. Learn more about viewing grades.

## 2.9 Where can I find my group and group space?

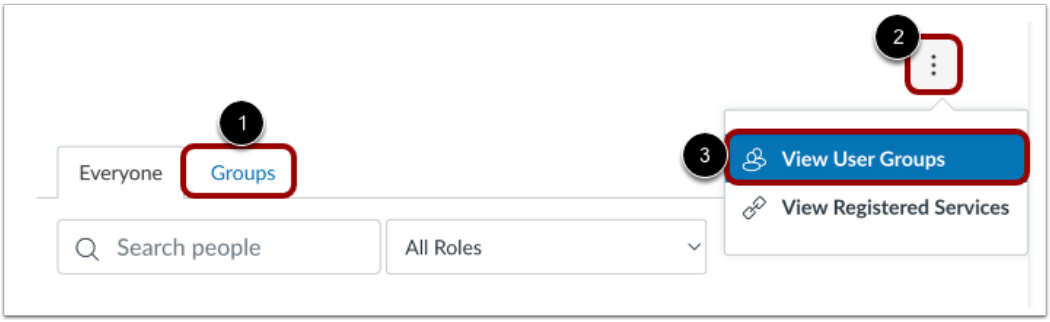
You can access your groups from:

- The right sidebar on the course **Home page** under **Course Groups**
- The **Groups** tab under **People** in the course navigation
- The **Groups** drop-down menu in the main Canvas navigation, showing all groups you belong to

Learn more about Canvas groups.

## 2.10 How do I sign up for a group in my course?

Inside your course, click **People** in the left menu. Then click **View User Groups** or the **Groups** tab. Find the desired group and click **JOIN**. Learn more about joining groups.




## 2.11 Does every member of my group need to submit a Group Assignment?

No, only one member needs to submit on behalf of the group. Check with your instructor for any specific submission instructions. Learn more about group assignment submission.

## 2.12 How do I send a message to someone in my course?

Use **Conversations (Inbox)** to communicate with instructors, group members, or fellow students in courses you're enrolled in. Conversations are like emails but don't have cc or spell-check features. Access this by clicking **Inbox** at the top right of Canvas. Learn how to send messages.

To receive instant email notifications for messages, set the **Conversations** notification preference to **Notify immediately**.

Learn more and adjust your notifications here: Canvas notification | How to manage my notification settings. Also available for: Android | iOS

## 2.13 What do I do if I fail to sign in to Collaborations with Office 365?

If you encounter sign-in issues with Collaborations using your HKUST Office 365 account, please follow the steps to reset the token.

## 2.14 What should I do if I fail to connect Google Drive in Canvas?

If you are unable to sign in or connect your Google Drive when using Collaborations or submitting Google Docs in Canvas, please reset your token by follow steps in Troubleshooting Google Drive Issues in Canvas (HKUST).

# 3 More help with Canvas

You can get more help with Canvas by using the Help link from the top right menu in Canvas. The Help link consists of a list of resources to help you with Canvas as follows:

## 3.1 Search the Canvas Guides

Canvas has a detailed student guide which you can access here.

You can also always search for an answer about a Canvas feature from the **Help** link in the top right corner, **Search the Canvas Guides**. This link will take you to Canvas Guides where you can search Canvas documentation for information about features inside of Canvas.

## 3.2 Report problems to our Helpdesk

If you are experiencing problems that have not been addressed by the above-mentioned channels of help or if you have any user account related enquiries, please feel free to contact our Helpdesk at canvas@ust.hk or call our hotline ☎ 2358-8036 from 09:00 - 12:45 and 14:00 - 17:30, Mon - Fri.

## 3.3 Copyright Information

**Must be "Fair Dealing"**

The Copyright Ordinance of Hong Kong allows instructors and students at non-profit education institutions like HKUST to use copyright works up to a "reasonable amount" for education purposes on the condition that such usage is considered fair dealing as provided in Section 41A of the Copyright Ordinance. The Fair Dealing tab of this guide provides more information.

**Uploading content**

When uploading the "reasonable amount" for instruction onto an intranet (like Canvas) you must fulfil the following requirements.

1. Acknowledge the source of the material properly;
2. Adopt access controls, such as logins and passwords and disseminate material on a need-to-know basis (i.e. only accessible to a specific group of staff or students for a limited time); and
3. Ensure that the maximum uploading period of the material does not exceed a consecutive period of **12 months**.

**E-Reserve & Course Packs**

1. Maybe there is no need for copying or uploading. Consider having the library make links to material that the university has already purchased via library subscriptions. Or you might need to license the material you wish to assign via a course pack.
2. Read the E-Reserve & Course Packs tab for details.

**Questions?**

Please get in touch with HKUST's representative on the Joint University Librarians Advisory Committee (JULAC) Copyright Committee, Ms Victoria F. Caplan (Extn. 6756; lbcaplan@ust.hk) if you have further questions. For more copyright-related information, please refer to the resources provided by the library.

## 3.4 Terms of Service Agreement and Privacy Policy for Canvas

By using the HKUST Learning Management System, Canvas, provided by Instructure Inc., users are agreeing to be bound by the terms and conditions. (see https://ilearn.ust.hk/canvas/canvas-user-agreement/index.html).

By using Canvas, your use of Canvas is also governed by Instructure's Terms of Use (see http://www.instructure.com/policies/terms-of-use) and you are also consenting to the collection and use of information by Instructure according to their Privacy Policy (see https://www.instructure.com/privacy-security).